

Data Dictionary

Facility_ID: Unique hospital identifier in the form of a six-digit numeric value (ex. 010001). It is a text datatype to accommodate leading zeroes. This is the index.

Facility_Name: Name of the hospital. It is a text datatype (ex. MIZELL MEMORIAL HOSPITAL).

City_Town: City or town where the hospital is located. It is a text datatype (ex. Denver).

State: Two letter state abbreviation for the hospital's location. It is a text datatype (ex. CO).

ZIP_Code: Five-digit numeric value for the hospital's location. It has a text datatype to preserve leading 0s (ex. 02354).

Census_Division: The Census Division to which a state belongs. There are nine Census Divisions in the U.S. (ex. CO is in the Mountain division).

Hospital_Type: An indicator of the types of services that a hospital provides. It has a text datatype (ex. Acute Care Hospitals).

Hospital_Ownership: The type of entity that owns the hospital. It has a text datatype (ex. Voluntary non-profit - Private).

Emergency_Services: A binary indicator of whether or not emergency services are provided at the hospital. The two choices are 'Yes' and 'No'.

Hospital_Overall_Rating: CMS-assigned star rating for the hospital. The values are floats ranging from 1.0 (worst) to 5.0 (best). The original ratings were integers. They have been converted to floats to allow for nulls.

Size_Indicator: A numeric value with a text datatype. CMS rates hospitals in cohorts according to these three sizes (Small, Medium, Large).

Outcomes: A numeric value with a float datatype. This value is calculated from three datasets (Mortality, Readmissions, and Infections) and is in the form of a z-score (ex. 0.234277 or -1.460909).

Per_Episode_Cost: A dollar figure with a float datatype (ex. 25745.0). This is the average total cost of an episode for a single hospital patient. It represents the cost in USD of all medical care from 3 days before admission to the hospital to 30 days after discharge from the hospital (this time period constitutes an episode).

Value_Quadrant: A text description of the hospital's outcome / cost quadrant. There are 4 possible values: 'high outcome, low cost', 'high outcome, high cost', 'low outcome, low cost', and 'low outcome, high cost'. A hospital with an Outcome score higher than the median value is termed 'high outcome'. All others are 'low outcome'. A hospital with a Per_Episode_Cost lower than the median value is termed 'low cost'. All others are 'high cost'.

Cleanliness: A numeric rating of room cleanliness. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Nurse_Communication: A numeric rating of how well nurses explained situations so that patients could understand. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Doctor_Communication: A numeric rating of how well doctors explained situations so that patients could understand. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Communication_About_Medicines: A numeric rating of how well information about medicines was explained so patients could understand. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Discharge_Information: A numeric rating of how well information about help available after discharge was explained. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Quietness: A numeric rating of how quiet patient rooms were at night. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Never to Sometimes to Usually to Always.

Would_Recommend: A numeric rating of whether or not patients would recommend the hospital. It is a star rating value between 1 and 5 that is calculated from patient responses to a Likert scale question where possible selections range from Definitely or Probably No to Probably or Definitely Yes.

Head_CT_Results_Quick: A percentage indicating the percentage of times when CT or MRI scans for strokes were interpreted within 45 minutes of the patient's arrival to the ED.

Sepsis_Appropriate_Care: A percentage indicating the percentage of times when patients who were experiencing severe sepsis or septic shock were provided the appropriate treatment.

ED_Wait_Time: A numeric value indicating the median time in minutes between a patient's arrival to the ED to their departure from the ED for patients who were discharged. Because fewer minutes are better, the values have been made negative to aid overall interpretability.

Left_ED_Not_Seen: A percentage indicating the percentage of ED patients who left the ED without being seen. Because lower percentages are better, the values have been made negative to aid overall interpretability.